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PKN Orlen

Reading the Room: Anticipated CFO Questions & Demo Guidance SE Demo Preparation Brief

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Prepared for: EMEA Sales Engineering Team

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Account: PKN Orlen S.A.

Classification: Snowflake Internal — Confidential

This document was prepared by Mark Deprez ahead of the April 22nd discovery meeting with PKN Orlen S.A. — Poland's largest energy group with PLN 267 billion in annual revenue, 200+ subsidiary companies across 14+ countries, and a PLN 350–380 billion investment programme running through 2035. Orlen is an active AI buyer (Microsoft partnership, July 2025) and has an ongoing EPM platform evaluation. This brief maps the CFO's likely questions directly to demo assets the team should stage before the meeting.

INTRODUCTION & HOW TO USE THIS DOCUMENT

I've put together this brief ahead of our April 22nd meeting with PKN Orlen. The goal is to give the SE team a precise, account-specific guide — not a generic energy sector playbook. Everything below maps directly to what Sławomir Jędrzejczyk (VP Financials, effectively CFO) will care about, drawn from our historical engagement history and Orlen's current strategic context. Please read the CFO questions before you start building demos — understanding why he'll ask them is more important than having a perfect slide.

How to use this document:

- Read the CFO questions first — understand what Jędrzejczyk actually cares about.
- Read the SE Guidance box — prepare the demo asset or dashboard before April 22nd.
- Don't show every capability — show ONE compelling use case per topic area and let the CFO ask for more.
- Lead with Orlen-specific numbers (PLN 267bn revenue, 200+ entities, 14+ countries) not generic demos.
- Anticipate the Microsoft challenge — “we already have Copilot” — and have a crisp 60-second answer ready.

Document Structure:

Cluster 1: Scenario Planning & Financial Volatility
Cluster 2: Group Consolidation & Multi-Entity Reporting
Cluster 3: CapEx Programme Management & Project Finance
Cluster 4: Energy Transition & ESG Reporting
Cluster 5: Data Unification & The Microsoft Question
Cluster 6: AI & Autonomous Analytics (SnowWork / Cortex)
Cluster 7: Data Sovereignty, Security & Polish Regulatory Compliance
Cluster 8: Commercial & Implementation Realism
Closing: Mark Deprez's April 22nd Readiness Checklist

CLUSTER 1: SCENARIO PLANNING & FINANCIAL VOLATILITY

Context

In 2024, Orlen recorded PLN 13.5 billion in impairments — the single largest write-down in Polish corporate history. In 2025 they reversed to a PLN 11.2 billion net profit. This kind of extreme swing is not a one-off — energy price volatility, carbon pricing, FX exposure (NOK, USD, EUR, PLN all material), and geopolitical supply shocks are structural features of Orlen's world.

Anticipated CFO Questions

1. *"Our P&L swung from PLN 13.5 billion in impairments to PLN 11.2 billion net profit in twelve months. Before I consider any new platform, I need to understand: can your system hold our actual historical scenario assumptions alongside actuals, so I can see — in retrospect — which assumptions were right and which were catastrophically wrong? Not just the outcome, the reasoning chain."*
2. *"I need to run 10 to 15 macro scenarios simultaneously — Brent crude at \$60, \$75, \$90; PLN/USD from 3.8 to 4.5; carbon price at €40, €80, €120 per tonne; Norwegian gas spot prices. Can your platform update my group EBITDA projection across all 200+ entities in real time when I change one of those inputs, or do I still need a data engineer to run a pipeline overnight?"*
3. *"When we paused the Olefins III project in 2024, the decision took months partly because we lacked a unified view of the downstream impact — on refining margins, on feedstock procurement, on our Lithuanian operations. How does our platform help me see that interconnected impact in hours, not months?"*
4. *"Who in my finance team actually uses this — the CFO office, the FP&A team, treasury? Or do I need a data science team to get value out of it? Give me a specific answer for each user type."*

// SE DEMO GUIDANCE

What to build for April 22nd — Scenario Modeling

- Stage a demo environment with 3 pre-built macro scenarios: Base / Downside (low oil, high carbon) / Upside (high oil, low carbon).
- Show a single dashboard where changing one slider (e.g., Brent crude price) cascades through refining margin → EBITDA by segment → net debt position.
- Use segment labels matching Orlen's actual structure: Upstream & Supply, Downstream, Energy, Consumers & Products.
- Include a 'scenario comparison' view showing all three side by side with delta columns — this is what the CFO's FP&A team would actually use in a budget review.
- If possible: show a 'scenario history' — how assumptions from 12 months ago compared to what actually happened. This directly answers question 1.
- Key user mapping: CFO office = scenario dashboards. FP&A = build/run scenarios. Treasury = cash-flow impact view. No data science team needed for any of these.

Key message: "This runs in seconds, not overnight. And your FP&A analyst can run it — not a data engineer."

CLUSTER 2: GROUP CONSOLIDATION & MULTI-ENTITY REPORTING

Context

Orlen completed the LOTOS and PGNiG mergers in 2022, expanding from a single refiner to a 200+ company group operating in 14+ countries. The group now spans Poland, Lithuania, Czech Republic, Germany, Austria, Slovakia, Canada, and Norway. Financial systems are not unified. Chart of accounts differs by entity. Local GAAP requirements vary. The CFO is signing IFRS-consolidated group accounts that aggregate data from dozens of source systems.

Anticipated CFO Questions

- 1. "I have 200 companies. Some run SAP, some run Oracle, some run legacy systems that were never designed to talk to each other. When PGNiG came in, we inherited their entire ERP landscape. How does our platform ingest from all of these without a three-year data migration project? Give me a realistic answer — not a slide about connectors."*
- 2. "My group consolidation cycle currently takes — I won't say how many days, but it's too many. At our scale, every day of close cycle that I can eliminate is a day earlier I can give the market accurate information. What is a realistic reduction in consolidation cycle time that a company our size has seen with our platform?"*
- 3. "Intercompany eliminations across 200+ entities, multiple currencies, multiple tax jurisdictions. When I consolidate, I need to eliminate PLN 30–40 billion in intercompany flows correctly. Does our platform handle the elimination logic, or does it just show me raw data and leave the logic to my team?"*
- 4. "I need my Lithuanian CFO (Orlen Lietuva), my Czech CFO (Orlen Unipetrol), and my German operations team (Orlen Deutschland) to all see their own P&L in real time — but I need to see the group view. Can I set that up with a single data model, or do I need separate environments for each subsidiary?"*
- 5. "What does the audit trail look like? My external auditors (we publish IFRS-compliant group accounts) need to trace every number back to its source transaction. Can I give my auditors read-only access with a complete lineage trail, without exposing the entire data estate?"*

// SE DEMO GUIDANCE

What to build for April 22nd — Group Consolidation View

- Build a demo showing a 3-tier entity hierarchy: Group (Orlen S.A.) → Country/Business Unit → Legal Entity. Use real Orlen subsidiary names: Orlen Lietuva, Orlen Unipetrol, Orlen Deutschland, PKN Orlen S.A., Orlen Energy.
- Show a 'consolidation waterfall': entity results → intercompany eliminations → group EBITDA. This is the visual that will resonate most with Jędrzejczyk.
- Demonstrate role-based access: log in as 'Orlen Lietuva CFO' (sees only Lithuania), then switch to 'Group CFO' (sees everything). This answers questions 4 and 5 in one 2-minute demo.
- Show data lineage — click on a number in the group P&L and trace it back to the source record. Label it as 'your auditors can follow this trail.'
- Currency: show PLN as the group reporting currency with automatic translation from EUR/USD/CZK/NOK source data.
- Prepare a visual: 'Before' (20+ source systems, manual Excel consolidation, weeks) vs. 'After' (single platform, automated eliminations, days). This before/after framing is powerful for a CFO who has lived through the pain.

Key message: "Your Lithuanian CFO sees Mažeikiai. You see everything. One model, not three environments."

CLUSTER 3: CAPEX PROGRAMME MANAGEMENT & PROJECT FINANCE

Context

Orlen is running the largest investment programme in Polish corporate history — PLN 350–380 billion through 2035. In 2026 alone: Baltic Power (1.2 GW offshore wind, commissioning), New Chemicals in Płock, CCGT plants in Grudziądz and Ostrołęka, HVO plant in Płock. Simultaneously: refinancing a EUR 2 billion revolving credit facility and arranging EUR 2.4 billion in Export Credit Agency financing for New Chemicals. The CFO needs real-time visibility across all of this, simultaneously.

Anticipated CFO Questions

1. *"I am running six to ten major capital projects simultaneously. Baltic Power alone is EUR 4+ billion. My current challenge is that CapEx tracking, treasury cashflow, and P&L impact are in three different systems. Can our platform give me one dashboard where I see: spend to date vs. budget, projected completion date, remaining financing drawdown, and P&L impact — for every major project, updated daily?"*
2. *"When a project slips — Baltic Power's commissioning schedule, for example — I need to immediately see the cash flow impact across treasury, the covenant implications on my credit facilities, and the EBITDA delivery risk for the year. Does our platform surface that chain of impact automatically, or do I need to run manual reports?"*
3. *"We are arranging EUR 2.4 billion in ECA financing for New Chemicals. That involves complex drawdown schedules tied to construction milestones. How does our platform integrate with my treasury management system to give me real-time drawdown vs. availability?"*
4. *"My maintenance CAPEX is PLN 77–88 billion over the decade — refinery shutdowns, pipeline integrity, grid upgrades. This isn't glamorous, but a missed maintenance window at the Płock refinery can cost me PLN 500 million in lost throughput. How does our platform help me track maintenance schedules against production capacity and financial impact?"*
5. *"I have external investors and rating agencies (Moody's A3, Fitch BBB+) who watch our leverage ratios very closely. Net debt/EBITDA moved from +0.23x at end-2024 to -0.07x at end-2025 — the best in our history. I need to be able to model 'what does our leverage ratio look like if we accelerate New Chemicals spending by 20%?' in real time. Can you show me that?"*

// SE DEMO GUIDANCE

What to build for April 22nd — CapEx & Project Finance Dashboard

- Build a CapEx portfolio view with 5-6 projects using real Orlen project names: Baltic Power, New Chemicals (Nowa Chemia), CCGT Grudziądz, CCGT Ostrołęka, HVO Płock, Hydrocracking Mažeikiai.
- Each project row: budget (PLN bn), spend to date, % complete, projected completion, remaining financing, P&L impact flag (on/off track).
- Show a 'trigger scenario': move Baltic Power commissioning date by 6 months → watch the EBITDA delivery for 2026 automatically recalculate → watch net debt/EBITDA ratio update → watch credit covenant headroom change. This is the 'chain of impact' the CFO asked for in question 2.
- Include a leverage dashboard: Net Debt / EBITDA ratio gauge, with a slider for 'additional CapEx acceleration' showing how the ratio moves. Use actual Orlen numbers: net debt -0.07x as baseline.
- For maintenance CapEx (question 4): show a Gantt-style timeline of refinery turnaround windows overlaid with production capacity impact. This visual is unusual in a demo and will differentiate from competitors.

Key message: "You asked 'what happens if New Chemicals spend accelerates 20%?' — here's the answer, in 30 seconds."

CLUSTER 4: ENERGY TRANSITION & ESG REPORTING

Context

Orlen published its first ESRS-compliant sustainability report in 2024 — a regulatory requirement under CSRD. The CFO must now sign off on carbon emissions data, EU Taxonomy alignment, and ESG KPIs with the same legal weight as financial statements. The 2035 Strategy commits to 12.8 GW of renewables, net zero by 2050, and a 25% absolute reduction in Scope 1+2 emissions by 2035 (vs. 2019 baseline). Baltic Power (1.2 GW, commissioning 2026) will be the largest single renewable asset in Polish history.

Anticipated CFO Questions

1. *"CSRD made me legally responsible for ESG data with the same accountability as financial data. My external auditors now sign off on my carbon numbers. I cannot have carbon data in one system, financial data in another, and then manually reconcile them for the report. Can our platform be the single system of record for both?"*
2. *"EU Taxonomy compliance means I must classify every capital expenditure as 'green', 'transitional', or 'not aligned'. I have PLN 32+ billion in annual CapEx. How does our platform help me classify, track, and report that taxonomy alignment at project level, not just at group level?"*
3. *"When Baltic Power comes online in 2026, it will generate 1.2 GW of clean electricity. I need to track: carbon avoided per MWh, green certificate revenue, Scope 2 impact across the group, and the EU Taxonomy classification — all in one place. Is that possible in our platform, or do I need a specialist ESG platform on top?"*
4. *"My credit facilities increasingly have sustainability-linked loan covenants — if I miss a carbon reduction target, my interest rate goes up. I need to monitor my progress against those covenants in real time, not at year-end when it's too late to act. How does our platform support that?"*
5. *"My rating agencies are watching ESG scores increasingly. If Moody's or Fitch downgrade my ESG rating, my refinancing cost in 2026 goes up. Can our platform help me model what ESG metric movements do to my credit rating sensitivity?"*

// SE DEMO GUIDANCE

What to build for April 22nd — ESG & Taxonomy Dashboard

- Build a dual-pane dashboard: LEFT = financial metrics (EBITDA, net debt, CapEx by project), RIGHT = ESG metrics (Scope 1/2/3 emissions, renewable capacity MW, carbon intensity per revenue unit, EU Taxonomy % aligned CapEx).
- Show them side by side — this is the 'single system of record' argument made visually.
- Include a 'taxonomy classification' drill-down: take the Baltic Power project, show it classified as EU Taxonomy-aligned, show the green CapEx percentage at group level, show the green bond proceeds tracked against it.
- Show a 'covenant monitor': a simple traffic-light dashboard tracking carbon reduction progress vs. target (green = on track, amber = at risk, red = breach). Label it 'sustainability-linked loan covenant tracker.'
- Connect the ESG dashboard to the financial model: show how missing a carbon target by X% would increase interest expense by Y basis points across the debt portfolio. This links ESG to P&L in a way a CFO finds compelling.

Key message: "Your auditors, your treasury team, and your IR team all look at the same number. There is no reconciliation step."

CLUSTER 5: DATA UNIFICATION & THE MICROSOFT QUESTION

Context

In July 2025, Orlen announced 'the largest AI implementation in Central Europe' — a partnership with Microsoft covering Copilot licenses, cloud consolidation, an internal AI competence center, and agentic AI pilots. Michał Furman (Executive Director of Digital Transformation and IT) led the announcement. Robert Soszyński (COO) endorsed it publicly. This is the CFO's most important challenge to us: 'we already have Microsoft — make the case.'

Anticipated CFO Questions

1. *"We signed with Microsoft in July 2025. We are deploying Copilot across 60,000 employees. We are consolidating cloud licenses. We are building an internal AI competence center. Convince me in two minutes why I need Snowflake on top of that. And do not say 'we complement each other' without a concrete example."*
2. *"Microsoft Fabric is Microsoft's data platform. Azure Data Lake exists. Power BI is widely deployed in our organization. Why is Snowflake better for my use case than Microsoft's own data stack — and be honest about where Microsoft is stronger."*
3. *"My IT team told me that Copilot is only as good as the data it can access. Right now, our data is fragmented across SAP, Oracle, legacy SCADA systems, and 200+ subsidiary reporting environments. Is Snowflake the answer to making Copilot actually work, or is that Microsoft's answer?"*
4. *"If I put my financial data in Snowflake and my AI layer is Microsoft Copilot — can they actually talk to each other natively, or do I need a custom integration that becomes a maintenance burden?"*
5. *"I have a data governance team that is responsible for data quality, access control, and lineage. They are currently setting policy for which systems get Microsoft Purview governance. If I bring in Snowflake, does that create two governance frameworks I have to reconcile, or does Snowflake work inside Microsoft Purview?"*

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What to build for April 22nd — The Microsoft Co-existence Story

- This is the most critical demo moment. Do NOT try to position us against Microsoft. Position our platform as the data foundation that makes Microsoft Copilot work.
- Prepare a one-slide architecture diagram: SAP / Oracle / Legacy Systems → Snowflake (unified, governed, AI-ready data layer) → Microsoft Copilot / Fabric / Power BI (consume the clean data). Label it 'The two-layer model.'
- If possible: demonstrate a live Copilot query that pulls clean, governed data from our platform via Azure integration. This shows the partnership is real, not theoretical.
- Have a crisp honest answer ready for question 2: 'Microsoft Fabric is excellent for Microsoft-native workloads. We win on multi-cloud data sharing, vendor neutrality, and the Data Clean Room use cases that matter at Orlen's scale.'
- For question 5: explain our native integration with Microsoft Purview for unified governance. Show a governance lineage that spans both systems.
- Prepare a 'Why both?' one-pager comparing what Microsoft does well (productivity AI, Office integration, identity) vs. what we do well (cross-platform data unification, multi-source governance, vendor neutrality, data sharing). Honest. Concise.

Key message: "Copilot without Snowflake is an AI built on fragmented data. We give Copilot a single, auditable source of truth across all 200+ entities."

CLUSTER 6: AI & AUTONOMOUS ANALYTICS (SNOWWORK / CORTEX)

Context

Orlen's CFO has 60,000 employees and a PLN 267 billion revenue operation. He cannot afford to have every analytical question require a data engineering ticket. He is also aware — after the Microsoft announcement — that AI is a strategic asset, not just a tool. The question is what AI actually does for a CFO at this scale, as opposed to what the slide deck says it does.

Anticipated CFO Questions

1. *"Microsoft showed me Copilot writing emails and summarizing documents. That's not what I need. I need AI that can tell me: 'Your Downstream margin will miss the Q3 budget by PLN 800 million unless you act on these three things in the next 30 days.' Can your AI do that — and can it show me its reasoning, not just its conclusion?"*
2. *"I want to ask the system a question in plain language: 'What drove the difference between our Q4 2025 actual EBITDA and our budget, broken down by segment and by country?' and get an answer that a non-technical person in my CFO office can read and act on. Show me that."*
3. *"My treasury team manages EUR 2 billion in revolving credit and PLN 47 billion in operating cash flows annually. Can your AI flag in real time when a cash flow pattern deviates from forecast — not at month-end, but when it's happening — and alert my treasury manager automatically?"*
4. *"We are building an internal AI competence center with Microsoft. How does Snowflake fit into that — can Orlen's data scientists use our platform as a development environment for custom AI models that then serve the finance function?"*
5. *"I need to know: is the AI making decisions, or is it surfacing options for humans to decide? I am the CFO of a critical national infrastructure operator. I cannot have an AI making procurement or treasury decisions autonomously. Where is the human in the loop?"*
6. *"What happens when the AI is wrong? Give me a real example where a Snowflake AI agent gave a customer a wrong answer, and explain what the guard-rail was that caught it."*

// SE DEMO GUIDANCE

What to build for April 22nd — AI / Cortex / SnowWork Demo

- The killer demo for question 2: stage a natural language query interface. The CFO types: 'What drove the difference between our Q4 2025 EBITDA actual and our budget by segment?' — show the system return a structured answer with segment breakdown, variance drivers ranked by size, and a recommendation. Use Orlen's actual Q4 2025 numbers: actual EBITDA PLN 12.2bn, label the segments.
- For question 1 (proactive alerting): show a 'margin alert' — a scenario where Downstream margin is tracking 8% below budget mid-quarter, and the system sends an automated alert to the CFO dashboard with three suggested interventions.
- For question 3 (treasury): show a cash flow deviation alert — actual daily cash flow vs. rolling 30-day forecast, with an alert threshold.
- For question 5 (human in the loop): be ready to explain our agentic AI governance model. The AI surfaces options with confidence scores; a human approves before any action is taken. Have this answer crisp and credible.
- For question 6 (when AI is wrong): prepare an honest answer. Acknowledge that hallucination is a known risk; explain the guard-rails (data grounding in our governed layer, confidence thresholds, audit logs). A CFO who runs critical national infrastructure will respect honesty far more than a polished non-answer.
- Stage the demo with Orlen-specific data labels — segment names, PLN currency, Polish-language option available. Generic 'Acme Corp' demos will not land.

Key message: "The AI surfaces the question. You make the decision. The data is yours, governed, in Poland, auditable."

CLUSTER 7: DATA SOVEREIGNTY, SECURITY & POLISH REGULATORY COMPLIANCE

Context

PKN Orlen is classified as critical national infrastructure in Poland. It operates refineries, gas distribution networks, and electricity grids serving millions of Polish citizens. After Russia's invasion of Ukraine in 2022, the Polish government and Orlen significantly increased cybersecurity investment. Paweł Wojtunik, Member of the Management Board for Security and Risk, is a former senior intelligence official. The board has cybersecurity as a first-class governance topic.

Anticipated CFO Questions

1. *"I am critical national infrastructure. The Polish government has specific requirements about where our data can be stored and who can access it. Does Snowflake have a data residency option that guarantees my financial data stays in Poland or the EU, with no access from US-based engineers or government agencies without Polish court order?"*
2. *"We have been working with Siemens on industrial cybersecurity — private 5G at our Płock refinery, SCADA integration, operational technology security. Financial data and operational technology data are converging. What is Snowflake's security posture when OT data starts flowing alongside financial data in the same environment?"*
3. *"After Russia's invasion, we discovered that some of our financial systems had vendor relationships that touched Russian infrastructure. We spent 18 months cleaning that up. I need a complete audit of where Snowflake's infrastructure, sub-processors, and dependencies sit geographically. Can you give me that documentation before the meeting?"*
4. *"RBAC — role-based access control. I need my Lithuanian CFO to see Lithuanian data only, my treasury team to see cash and debt data only, and my CapEx team to see project spend only. And I need that policy to be enforced at the data layer, not at the application layer. Can you demonstrate that?"*
5. *"We are subject to Polish KSC (Cybersecurity of Critical Infrastructure) regulations, NIS2 across the EU, and GDPR for any personal data in our HR and retail systems. Does Snowflake have a compliance documentation pack for all three? And who is the named compliance contact at Snowflake for a Polish critical infrastructure operator?"*

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What to build for April 22nd — Security & Sovereignty Demo

- Prepare a one-page data residency fact sheet for Orlen specifically: our EU data residency options (Warsaw/Frankfurt regions), GDPR compliance documentation, NIS2 posture, and the answer to 'can a US engineer access my data without my consent.' Have this as a printed leave-behind, not just a slide.
- For RBAC (question 4): build a live demo. Log in as 'Orlen Lietuva CFO' — show they can only see Lithuanian P&L. Log in as 'Group CFO' — show they see everything. Log in as 'Treasury Manager' — show they see only cash and debt dashboards. This is a 3-minute demo that answers the governance question completely.
- For question 3 (supply chain audit): be ready to share our sub-processor list and geographic infrastructure map. This is a prerequisite for any deal — have it ready before the meeting, not as a follow-up.
- For KSC/NIS2 (question 5): coordinate with our compliance team before April 22nd to confirm who the named contact is for Polish critical infrastructure. This question will be asked.
- Prepare a compliance matrix table: Regulation (GDPR, NIS2, KSC) × Requirement × Snowflake Capability × Documentation Reference. Leave-behind format. This shows preparation, not improvisation.

Key message: "Your data stays in the EU. Your rules define who sees what. We can prove it to your auditors and your regulator."

CLUSTER 8: COMMERCIAL & IMPLEMENTATION REALISM

Context

Jędrzejczyk is a seasoned CFO who has sat through hundreds of vendor pitches. He has seen EPM vendors over-promise and under-deliver. He was Orlen CFO from 2008–2017 — he watched the SAP rollout, the Oracle expansions, and multiple EPM vendor evaluations. He will not be moved by demos alone. He needs to understand the commercial and implementation reality.

Anticipated CFO Questions

1. *"What does this actually cost for a company our size? I want a realistic total cost of ownership — licenses, implementation, data engineering, change management, training — for a 200+ entity group using Snowflake for financial analytics and group consolidation. Give me a number, not a 'it depends.'"*
2. *"How long until I see value? Not full deployment — the first use case that is live and producing actionable results for my finance team. What is the realistic timeline from contract signature to first dashboard in production?"*
3. *"Who implements this? Snowflake itself, or a system integrator? Which SIs in Poland or CEE actually have the Snowflake skills to do this at our scale? Give me three names."*
4. *"What does migration actually look like? I have data in SAP S/4HANA, Oracle EBS, and at least a dozen legacy reporting tools. What is the realistic sequence — do I have to migrate everything before I get value, or can I run Snowflake in parallel and migrate incrementally?"*
5. *"Give me one reference — one energy company of comparable scale in Europe — who has done what you are proposing to us. I want to call their CFO, not read a case study."*
6. *"What happens at renewal? What has happened to Snowflake pricing in the last three years? I've seen cloud vendor contracts where the renewal cost was 40% higher than the initial deal. How do I protect against that?"*

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What to build for April 22nd — Commercial Readiness

- This is not a demo section — it is a preparation section. Before April 22nd, the team must have answers ready for all six questions above. Do not go into the meeting without them.
- For question 1 (TCO): prepare a ballpark range — e.g., ‘for a group of your scale, first-year investment is typically in the range of X to Y, with the majority of that being implementation and data engineering, not license.’ Be honest. If you don’t have a number, say you will have a detailed estimate within 5 business days.
- For question 3 (Polish SIs): identify at least two Polish or CEE-based Snowflake partners with energy sector experience. Likely candidates include Deloitte Poland, Accenture Poland, or regional data engineering firms. Confirm with our partner team before April 22nd.
- For question 5 (reference): identify one European energy or utility company using Snowflake at group consolidation scale. Ideally a company with 100+ legal entities. Prepare a two-paragraph summary of their use case. If the reference call can be arranged, offer it.
- For question 6 (pricing protection): be ready to explain our consumption-based pricing model — the CFO will find this reassuring compared to seat-based SaaS. Explain how commitments work and how pricing has evolved. Do not hide the renewal risk question.
- Prepare a ‘first 180 days’ timeline slide: Month 1–2 = data onboarding + first dashboard, Month 3–4 = consolidation pilot, Month 5–6 = expanded rollout. Concrete, with named milestones. The CFO has seen ‘agile transformation’ slides before. He wants a Gantt chart.

Key message: “We will not promise what we cannot deliver. Here is what the first six months look like — honest, specific, and with a reference you can call.”

MARK DEPREZ'S APRIL 22ND READINESS CHECKLIST

Use this checklist to track preparation status. Every item should be complete and tested before the meeting. I'm accountable for sign-off — reach me directly if you need support on any item.

#	Checklist Item	Status
1	Scenario modeling dashboard staged with Orlen segment structure (Upstream & Supply, Downstream, Energy, Consumers & Products)	
2	Group consolidation hierarchy built: Orlen S.A. → Orlen Lietuva, Unipetrol, Orlen Deutschland, etc.	
3	RBAC demo configured: three login roles (Lietuva CFO / Group CFO / Treasury Manager)	
4	EU Taxonomy classification drill-down prepared (Baltic Power as example)	
5	SnowWork / Cortex AI natural language query staged with Orlen Q4 2025 financials	
6	Proactive margin alert demo configured (Downstream 8% below budget scenario)	
7	Microsoft co-existence architecture slide prepared (one diagram, not a deck)	
8	Data residency fact sheet printed (EU residency, GDPR, NIS2, KSC reference)	
9	Sub-processor list and geographic infrastructure map ready to share	
10	Polish / CEE SI partner names confirmed (minimum 2 names)	
11	European energy reference customer briefed and available for reference call	
12	TCO ballpark range agreed internally and approved to share	
13	Snowflake compliance contact for Polish critical infrastructure identified and named	
14	Leverage ratio slider demo: Net Debt/EBITDA impact of CapEx acceleration scenarios	
15	All demo environments tested on the morning of April 22nd — no live data engineering on the day	

Questions or demo prep support — reach me directly. Let's make this count. — Mark

SOURCES

1. PKN Orlen Q4 2025 Financial Results

https://www.orlen.pl/content/dam/internet/orlen/pl/en/investor-relations/reports-and-publications/financial-results/2025/4q2025/ORLEN_4Q-2025_Financial-Results.pdf

2. ORLEN Strategy 2035

<https://www.orlen.pl/en/about-the-company/strategy>

3. ORLEN Microsoft AI Partnership (July 2025)

<https://www.orlen.pl/en/about-the-company/media/press-releases/current/2025/july-2025/orlens-transformation-to-gain-momentum-with-cees-largest-ai-deployment>

4. Jędrzejczyk appointed VP Financials (Sep 2025)

<https://www.orlen.pl/en/investor-relations/reports-and-publications/regulatory-announcements/2025/03/Regulatory-announcement-no-46-2025>

5. HDIN Research ORLEN Financial Analysis 2024-2025

<https://www.hdinresearch.com/news/738>